Spotlight: PM's Address at Bloomberg New Economy Forum

News On Air Transcript • Akashvani • Word Count: 1,148

Introduction

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This is Akashvani in the program Spotlight. Now we bring you a discussion on the Prime Minister's address at the Bloomberg New Economy Forum. The participants are Deepshikha Sikarwar, economic analyst, and Shria Patak, anchor.

Shria Patak (Anchor): Hello and welcome to Spotlight. Prime Minister Narendra Modi, addressing the 8th Bloomberg New Economic Forum in New Delhi today, has highlighted the **vision** of "power to **empower**." He emphasized that **technological** progress should benefit every section of society, not just a **privileged** few. Before moving any further, let's listen to what the PM said.

> **Audio Clip (Prime Minister):** Government or power to **empower** global engagement... manufacturing capability.

Chapter 1: Power to Empower Vision

Shria Patak: To understand how this **vision** can shape India's economic future, we are joined by Dipshikha Sukarwar, economic analyst. Welcome to Spotlight, Dipshikha ma'am.

Dipshikha Sukarwar: Thank you, Shria.

Shria Patak: Today only, Dipshikha ma'am, the Prime Minister spoke about something worth remembering. He said, "power to **empower**." What, in your opinion, could this **vision** actually mean for India's economy?

Dipshikha Sukarwar: Uh, Shria, if you listen to what the Prime Minister said at the Bloomberg New Economy Forum in the National Capital today, two very important statements really stand out. One, of course, like you mentioned, "power to **empower**." I think what the Prime Minister is talking about is you attain power, but that has to be to **empower** others, and which has been the underlying **philosophy** behind whatever **initiatives** that the government has been taking: that the last mile or the last person should be empowered.

So, for any government, for any country or any government to be powerful, it should be to ensure empowerment of the person. The last person or the last mile, uh, should be your target.

The other important statement which I would like to highlight is which the Prime Minister mentioned: he pitched India as the reliable partner of the global south and also he mentioned the issue of trust—a trusted supplier in current circumstances when globally there is so much happening in the **geopolitical** and the geo-economic sphere. India stands out as a reliable and a trustworthy supplier, and that is something that the Prime Minister **reiterated** at the Bloomberg forum.

Chapter 2: Digital Infrastructure & Inclusive Growth

Shria Patak: While the Prime Minister was addressing this 8th Bloomberg New Economic Forum, he stressed on how India is moving towards the **vision** of Viksit Bharat and how it's becoming a **technological** hub. So how do you think that technology can make economic growth, especially in context to India, more **inclusive**?

Dipshikha Sukarwar: Shria, if you look at, you know, the entire digital infrastructure, the DPI, the digital payment infrastructure, India has set an example in terms of using technology to take the support of different forms to people. So, Jan Dhan accounts were opened, if you remember, and there was a major drive which was launched to ensure that every household has a bank account. Then these accounts were topped with funds, especially women's accounts during the COVID crisis. If you look at all the transfers, the DBT, the direct benefit transfers under various schemes, they use technology. So technology for India as a country and for the government has been a vehicle to ensure empowerment of people and to ensure various services or the support reach people in full form.

You know, there are no cuts involved in the entire chain. So the funds get transferred, uh, using technology. Small examples like, you know, when farmers sell their produce, they know when to reach a Mandi. These digital infrastructures have been put in place; they know on their mobile when they have to reach the Mandi. They reach the Mandi, the funds get transferred into their bank account. So the aspect of middlemen sort of coming in, taking away funds, all that has gone away.

Technology has ensured that funds reach people, and the development or empowerment at the last mile which we discussed earlier, that happens through the use of technology.

Chapter 3: Connectivity and Governance

Shria Patak: So, uh, the Prime Minister also highlighted, as you mentioned, how technology is making it easier for all the people in a country. How affordable internet access has connected people with knowledge and markets. So how has digital connectivity **transformed** opportunities for rural communities, especially small businesses and young people, in your opinion?

Dipshikha Sukarwar: We discussed one aspect of how the government has used technology in ensuring how its support reaches people. The other aspect is, and especially India has some of the lowest rates for internet usage, and we've seen the large-scale **penetration** of mobile and internet in the country which has been used not just to deliver services in rural and far-flung areas, but also it has been effectively used for people to set up their businesses, to carry out their businesses—especially, you know, small and, uh, medium firms, micro-enterprises, household **enterprises**. Technology is being used in every possible way.

Implementation of projects, construction of roads—it gets monitored right from New Delhi or right from state capitals. Uh, basically delivery of projects, the pace of projects, approval of projects. You know there is a PM Gati Shakti platform which is an interface of various ministries dealing with infrastructure. There is a dashboard which shows, you know, which project is in what state of approval or where is it stuck or, you know, what's holding it up. So technology is being made to ensure effective governance and delivery at the last mile, and this is at the government level.

But we've also seen that happen at the people-to-people level, you know, citizen level. So you can make a payment just using your mobile phone. So, you know, if you've forgotten your wallet, you can carry your mobile phone and make a payment everywhere, and right from the chaiwala to the zila everywhere. So India has effectively used technology and also the facility of cheap internet that is available to people in the country.

Chapter 4: AI and Workforce Evolution

Shria Patak: So before moving further in the discussion, let's listen to what the Prime Minister said on the AI impact summit and how it has benefited people and how animals will benefit from AI.

> **Audio Clip (Bloomberg):** [Audio regarding AI benefits]

Shria Patak: So we just heard the Prime Minister describing how AI would benefit **humanity**, and he described digital skills as a game-changer for India with artificial intelligence **continuously** **reshaping** industries and jobs. Which skills should India **prioritize** and how can its workforce prepare for these changes, as we see the youth nowadays fear that AI will take away the majority of jobs? Your opinion, ma'am?

Dipshikha Sukarwar: Shria, there is definitely a lot of confusion around and a lot of **apprehension** around how AI will pose **immense** challenges, and particularly in the form of loss of jobs. One thing which we have to understand is while there are fears, but also there is **immense** scope. If you look at the development of technologies in the past, technology has created opportunities. While one opportunity may not last or one kind of job may not last, there are different kinds of jobs that may get created.

So I think the full impact of technology, especially a technology like artificial intelligence, needs to be studied in more depth, but we also have to see, and a lot of experts globally are saying, that it may end up creating different kinds of jobs. It may be very different, and these fears may be **unfounded** as we move forward with its wider adoption. But I think from the government side, what is being sort of stressed is we need to have our own **sovereign** AI, and we need to use AI in improving delivery of various services—healthcare, education, and so on and so forth. So how best can we use AI in various aspects? There are farmers, there are apps which have been developed which use AI very effectively. So various use cases of AI are coming up, and these use cases will help create jobs.

Chapter 5: Support for Innovation

Shria Patak: As you rightly mentioned, ma'am, that how AI will actually create, uh, jobs, and with AI we see what has actually emerged is the growth of startups, including those in smaller cities, and especially women-led **enterprises**. What steps are needed to make entrepreneurship more accessible and ensure that actually **innovation** creates opportunities across different sections of society?

Dipshikha Sukarwar: AI will create multiple use cases, and those use cases will be developed by the startups in the country. And there is a lot of emphasis—we've seen the Commerce and Industry Minister, they're working very closely with the startups. MeitY, which handles the tech part, they are also working very closely with deep tech and tech startups to identify use cases to come up with, and to offer all kinds of support to basically the startup sector and also the other **enterprises** which want to work on AI uses. How best can it help, or how best can a business use AI?

I think there is a lot of support from the government side, particularly MeitY ministry is working with a lot of startups in this. The DPI is also working with some deep tech startups. There's a lot of support, there is a startup fund which is helping tech startups, so a lot of work is happening in that area. And from the government side, there is a lot of support on the policy front to help **enterprises**, help startups use technology, and to take it forward, and to ensure that it, you know, makes good business sense for them to work on a particular area using artificial intelligence.

Chapter 6: Global Digital Leadership

Shria Patak: Moving on to the next question, we see that India is already sharing its digital **capabilities** with countries in the global south. How can you say that India's digital public infrastructure supports economic development internationally, and what does this mean for India's role in the context of the global economy?

Dipshikha Sukarwar: We've seen during G20, India presented its DPI to the entire world, and it is there for everyone to see how effectively we have used the Aadhaar-based system to ensure that services, payment transfers, they are delivered to people directly at the last mile and very effectively. It has been appreciated by various countries who have in fact asked India to share its **expertise** in this area, and India also has offered the technology which it has. It has offered to share it, and it has offered to share even the source code so that the countries can work on it and develop their own models.

So the idea is that the global south particularly can use the example of India or look at the platform, delivery platform in India to how effectively DPI has been used in various forms. And, uh, it can work effectively; they don't have to reinvent the wheel, it is available for them, and it can be effectively used by them.

Shria Patak: So as we see that India **embraces** the **technological** change, the real test will be whether it creates opportunities for all and ensures that progress reaches every section of society and no one remains digitally excluded. Thank you, Dipshikha Sukarwar, for sharing your thoughtful insights on the 8th Bloomberg New Economy Forum today. Thank you.

You are listening to a discussion on the Prime Minister's address at the Bloomberg New Economy Forum. The participants were Dipshikha Sikarwar, economic analyst, and Shria Patak, anchor. This program was produced and presented by the News Services Division of Akashvani. You can listen to it on our mobile app News on AIR. This program is also available on our YouTube channel News on AIR Official.

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